

Multenions and Differential Invariants.—III.

BY ALEX. MCAULAY, PROFESSOR OF MATHEMATICS IN THE UNIVERSITY OF TASMANIA.

(Communicated by W. B. Hardy, Sec.R.S. Received July 20, 1921.)

§ 19. *SUGGESTED IMPROVEMENT OF SOME NOTATIONS AND TERMS.*—The reader has probably found that the terminology for multenion linities, adopted hitherto because of the writer's timid reluctance to depart from accepted meanings, is too inexpressive of the intended signification. A covariant linity fabricates a covariant multenion out of a contravariant. Let us call it a $c/\mathfrak{O}$ or a coexcontra (co-ex-contra); and similarly let us now denote a contravariant, comixt or contramixt linity by the name contraexco, coexco or contraexcontra, and by the symbol $\mathfrak{O}/c$, c/c or $\mathfrak{O}/\mathfrak{O}$ respectively. Let us also use parenthesis marks¹ before a letter such as ϕ , of the same general shapes as c and $\mathfrak{O}$ (omitting the solidus), to indicate the type of invariance, thus—let us say that

$$\phi = {}^{\circ}\phi, {}^{\circ}(\phi, ({}^{\circ}(\phi \text{ or } {}^{\circ}))\phi$$

indicates that ϕ is a

$$c/\mathfrak{O}, \quad \mathfrak{O}/c, \quad c/c \text{ or } \mathfrak{O}/\mathfrak{O}$$

respectively. Similarly, $p = {}^{\circ}p$ indicates that p is a covariant multenion and $q = {}^{\circ}q$ indicates that q is a contravariant multenion. If we actually insert all these indicating parenthesis marks, which we shall do but rarely, their mode of combination is simple. Thus

$$)p =))\phi {}^{\circ}(\psi (q$$

is an invariant equation. The features that render it so are (1) that the second mark of one letter, ϕ or ψ , is identical with the first mark of the next; these two marks virtually cancel one another; and (2) the proper mark of the resultant symbol p , of the whole operation, is the first written mark of the compound symbol $\phi\psi q$.

When with these notations we use the dash which indicates conjugacy, there is, unless we insert brackets, ambiguity in the meanings of $(F'$ and $)F'$ (the two mixed types as we have hitherto called them), because $((F)'$ is not of the same type c/c as $((F$, but of the type $\mathfrak{O}/\mathfrak{O}$. There is no such ambiguity with ${}^{\circ}\phi'$ and ${}^{\circ}(\phi'$ nor with $f(F$ and $f)F$, where fx is a rational function of x . [Remember that $f(\phi$ and $f)\phi$ have no invariative meaning. I think it

¹Intended by author to be *commas*, upright and inverted. In future printing the author still thinks commas would be preferable to the bracket substitute.

best to adhere to the general rule, not rigidly prescribed, that $c/\mathfrak{C}$ and $\mathfrak{C}/c$ should be denoted by Greek letters and c/c and $\mathfrak{C}/\mathfrak{C}$ by Roman capitals.]

Our new notations and terms apply to other symbols than invariantive; for instance, to Γ_β . Thus

$$\Gamma_\beta = \mathfrak{I}\Gamma_\beta, \quad E'_\beta = \mathfrak{I}(E'_\beta).$$

We shall retain the “cross” notation to indicate different symbols, and generally restrict it, without rigid prescription, to the same meanings as hitherto.

Our former $\bar{\Gamma}_\beta$ and $\bar{E}_\beta$ will henceforth not be used, because we have in §18 a new notation, according to which ${}^aE_\beta$ would have reference to a Weyl manifold, and would indicate that ${}^aE_\beta$ was the part of E_β not containing terms in λ ; and if λ is actually everywhere zero so that the manifold becomes a Riemann manifold, §18 provides the use of F_β in place of E_β . In the present paper we occupy ourselves exclusively with a Riemann manifold, and use the letters θ , l , F_β , Θ_β , Ω , C ($= \mathfrak{I}(C = \Omega\theta^{-1})$ provided for that case.

A thick dot² will be used to denote that a symbol is a “density,” though occasionally, as with W (action density), and f a part of W below, we shall not consider it necessary to use the dot. Once for all, we define $\dot{\eta}'$ and $\dot{\theta}$ by the equations

$$\dot{\eta}' = k\eta^{-1}, \quad \dot{\theta} = l\theta^{-1}. \quad (1)$$

but we may regard it as a rule, unless the contrary is definitely stated, as here with $\dot{\eta}'$ and $\dot{\theta}$, that the dot attached to a symbol means that the undotted symbol has been multiplied by l (by k if we were dealing with a Weyl manifold). Thus $\dot{C}$, $\dot{G}$ stand for lC , lG , and again, if we introduce $\dot{\kappa}$ as a contravariant vector density, then κ will mean $l^{-1}\dot{\kappa}$.

With regard to $\dot{\theta}$ in (1), we shall use it as applied to a general multenion, say, to $w^\times = V_a q^\times$, but not exactly with the extensive meaning. Thus $\dot{\theta}u^\times$ means $l\theta^{-1}u^\times$ where θ^{-1} but not l is used in the extensive meaning. Thus, for instance, $\dot{\theta}V_3\alpha^\times\beta^\times\gamma^\times$ means $lV_3\theta^{-1}\alpha^\times\theta^{-1}\beta^\times\theta^{-1}\gamma^\times$, and not $l^3V_3\theta^{-1}\alpha^\times\theta^{-1}\beta^\times\theta^{-1}\gamma^\times$.

§ 20. MAXWELL'S EQUATIONS FOR MATTER IN BULK.—It is fully time to show how the special requirements of Relativity are met in detail in our method. In now introducing Maxwell's equations, let us throughout keep in mind the application to matter in bulk. If for no other reason this is desirable because thereby we are prepared to accept the beautiful

²It is necessary, because of papers despatched to England in the early months of 1922, to state that this dot replaced a *bar* placed over the symbol affected. The replacement was made in August, 1922, at the suggestion of the printers. It seems now (August) too late to replace the bar in the papers just mentioned.

explanation that Maxwell's theory affords of the known behaviour of light in uniaxal and biaxal crystals. When we compare results with Maxwell's we shall speak as if $n = 4$. Nevertheless, in the general argument, we shall continue to suppose n to have any positive integral value. When with $n = 4$ we put

$$\rho = xl_1 + yl_2 + zl_3 + tl_4$$

we shall speak of x, y, z as the spatial co-ordinates and t as the time, even when by transformation of all four co-ordinates t may mean something very different from the time as ordinarily understood.

Let Maxwell's vector potential be $\mathbf{A} = (A_1, A_2, A_3)$, electrostatic potential $= A_4$, magnetic induction $\mathbf{B} = (B_1, B_2, B_3)$, electric intensity $\mathbf{E} = (E_1, E_2, E_3)$, magnetic field strength $\mathbf{H} = (H_1, H_2, H_3)$, dielectric displacement $\mathbf{D} = (D_1, D_2, D_3)$, conduction current $\mathbf{K} = (K_1, K_2, K_3)$, electrostatic density $= K_4$, force per unit volume $\mathbf{F} = (F_1, F_2, F_3)$, power $(-\mathbf{SEK})$ per unit volume $= F_4$.

Also let λ be a covariant vector (better use $\lambda^\times$ in the future) given by

$$\lambda = \sum A_c l_c \quad (c = 1, 2, 3, 4),$$

$\omega^\times$ a covariant ${}_nV_2$ given by

$$\omega^\times = \sum B_1 l_2 l_3 + \sum E_1 l_4 l_1$$

(the meaning of each summation, of three terms, being sufficiently obvious), $\dot{\omega}$ a contravariant ${}_nV_2$ density given by

$$\dot{\omega} = \sum H_1 l_2 l_3 + \sum D_1 l_4 l_1,$$

$\dot{\kappa}$ a contravariant vector density given by

$$\dot{\kappa} = \sum K_c l_c \quad (c = 1, 2, 3, 4),$$

and $\dot{v}^\times$ a covariant vector density given by

$$\dot{v}^\times = \sum F_c l_c \quad (c = 1, 2, 3, 4).$$

Maxwell's quaternion equations

$$\mathbf{B} = V\nabla\mathbf{A}, \quad \mathbf{E} = -\nabla A_4 - \partial\mathbf{A}/c\partial t, \quad (1)$$

$$\mathbf{K} = V\nabla\mathbf{H} - \partial\mathbf{D}/\partial t, \quad \mathbf{K}_4 = -S\nabla\mathbf{D}, \quad (2)$$

$$\mathbf{F} = V\mathbf{KB} + K_4\mathbf{E}, \quad \mathbf{F}_4 = -S\mathbf{KE}, \quad (3)$$

are identical with the multenion equations³

$$\omega^\times = V_2 \nabla \lambda, \quad (1a)$$

$$\dot{\kappa} = V_1 \nabla \dot{\omega}, \quad (2a)$$

$$\dot{v}^\times = V_1 \dot{\kappa} \omega^\times. \quad (3a)$$

The equations (1a), (2a), (3a) are all invariantive.

³For a convenient, simple, systematic method of converting all ($n = 4$) multenion formulae to corresponding quaternion formulae, see a paper by the author (despatched a month ago, viz., November, 1922, to England), "The Mechanical Forces ... in an Electromagnetic Field."

[A digression. In Maxwell's presentation of the fundamental aspects of the electromagnetic field $V\nabla\mathbf{H}$ in equation (2) is looked upon as *the* electric current, consisting of two parts, conduction current $\mathbf{K}$ and dielectric current $\partial\mathbf{D}/\partial t$. In the new Relativity scheme, as given by (2a), we naturally interchange the *rôles* of $V\nabla\mathbf{H}$ and $\mathbf{K}$; that is to say, we look upon $\mathbf{K}$ as *the* current, consisting of two parts, a magnetic part, $V\nabla\mathbf{H}$, and an electric part, $-\partial\mathbf{D}/\partial t$. In the multenion presentation (see below for N and I) $V\nabla\mathbf{H}$ is $V_1\nabla(N\dot{\omega})$, $-\partial\mathbf{D}/\partial t$ is $NV_1\nabla(I\dot{\omega})$, and K_4 (multiplied into l_4) is $IV_1\nabla(I\dot{\omega})$. [In the last sentence N and I are used as if $N = {}^{))}N$, $I = {}^{))}I$; if, as usual, we take $N = {}^{((}N$, $I = {}^{((}I$, then in the last sentence each N should be N' and each I should be I' .] In the future, then, when we use the term current, Maxwell's conduction current will be meant. Maxwell does not put $\mathbf{F} = V\mathbf{KB}$ as we have asserted in (3), but instead $\mathbf{F} = V(V\nabla\mathbf{H})\mathbf{B}$.]

Before speaking of the relations between Maxwell's $(\mathbf{B}, \mathbf{E})$ and $(\mathbf{H}, \mathbf{D})$, that is, between $\omega^\times$ and $\dot{\omega}$, let us derive Lorentz's generalizations of Maxwell's equations to bodies in motion from the general principle of Relativity. The generalisations in nowise alter (1a), (2a), (3a). Put N_4 and I_4 for the normal and incident components with reference to l_4 , when the co-ordinates are Galilean. In reality we have

$$\left. \begin{array}{ll} \mathbf{A} \text{ is } N_4\lambda, & l_4A_4 \text{ is } l_4\lambda \\ \mathbf{B} \text{ is } N_4\omega^\times, & \mathbf{E} \text{ is } l_4\omega^\times \end{array} \right\} \quad (1b)$$

$$\left. \begin{array}{ll} \mathbf{H} \text{ is } N_4\dot{\omega}, & \mathbf{D} \text{ is } l_4\dot{\omega} \\ \mathbf{K} \text{ is } N_4\dot{\kappa}, & l_4K_4 \text{ is } l_4\dot{\kappa} \end{array} \right\} \quad (2b)$$

$$\mathbf{F} \text{ is } N_4\dot{v}^\times, \quad l_4F_4 \text{ is } l_4\dot{v}^\times. \quad (3b)$$

In the general θ (Riemann) manifold

$$\iota = dp/ds = dp/\sqrt{(V_0 dp \theta dp)}$$

degenerates when Galilean co-ordinates are used ($\theta = 1$) to

$$\begin{aligned} & (l_1 dx + l_2 dy + l_3 dz + l_4 dt) / \sqrt{(-dx^2 - dy^2 - dz^2 + dt^2)} \\ &= (1 - \sum \dot{x}^2)^{-\frac{1}{2}} \cdot (l_1 \dot{x} + l_2 \dot{y} + l_3 \dot{z} + l_4), \end{aligned}$$

of which we say nothing more here than that when the co-ordinates are so chosen that the particle is at rest ι (the contravariant world unit tangent vector to the world locus of a particle), degenerates to l_4 . Maxwell's equations, as given above, are to be supposed true only when the medium is at rest. The generalisations of N_4 and I_4 are thus N and I (or N' and I'), the normal and incident components with reference to ι ; normal *component* and normal *expression*, in this case, meaning the same, because

$V_0 \mathfrak{t} \theta \mathfrak{t} = 1$. Below N and I will always mean what has just been described with reference to $\mathfrak{t}$, unless explicit exception is made; (1b), (2b), (3b), become like (1a), (2a), (3a), all invariantive when we read $\mathfrak{t}$, N and I in place of l_4 , N_4 , and I_4 , in (1a) and (3a); and in (2a), $\mathfrak{t}$, N' and I' in place of l_4 , N_4 , and I_4 . [Remember that $N = (N, N' =)(\psi$, and similarly for I .]

The equations this process gives when a body is moving, and we are using Galilean co-ordinates, are Lorentz's well-known generalizations of Maxwell's quaternion equations (not of our multenion equations, which have been in no way altered by what has been said).

From (1a) and (2a) we have of course

$$V_3 \nabla \omega^\times = 0, \quad (4)$$

$$V_0 \nabla \dot{\mathbf{K}} = 0. \quad (5)$$

These must be implicitly contained in (1) and (2) and indeed are found to be

$$S \nabla \mathbf{B} = 0, \quad V \nabla \mathbf{E} + \partial \mathbf{B} / \partial t = 0, \quad (4a)$$

$$S \nabla \mathbf{K} = \partial K_4 / \partial t. \quad (5a)$$

Maxwell's relations between $(\mathbf{B}, \mathbf{E})$ and $(\mathbf{H}, \mathbf{D})$ are that $\mathbf{H}$ is a self-conjugate linity of $\mathbf{B}$, (permeability) $^{-1}$; and $\mathbf{D}$ a similar function of $\mathbf{E}$, capacity. In our case

$$\left. \begin{aligned} \dot{\omega} &= \psi \omega^\times, & \psi &= \psi' =)(\psi \\ I' \psi N &= 0 = N' \psi I \end{aligned} \right\} \quad (6)$$

Here ψ is a ${}_n V_2$ linity concerning which, $\psi = \psi'$ asserts that ψ is self-conjugate, $\psi =)(\psi$ asserts that it is contraexco, the dot implies that it is a density, and the two equations in the second line assert that ψ consists of two parts $N' \psi N + I' \psi I$, of which the first is confined to normal components with reference to $\mathfrak{t}$, and the other to incident components.

[Any c/c , say ϕ , may be expressed uniquely as the sum of four parts thus

$$\phi = (N + I) \phi (N + I) = N \phi N + I \phi I + N \phi I + I \phi N.$$

With a $\mathfrak{O}/c$ the four parts are obtained from $(N + I)'$ () $(N + I)$, and in the case of ψ two of these parts are asserted in (6) to be zero.

Digression on I and N .—I have forgotten to point out earlier that I' , I , N' and N all have subextensive significance, and that $(I - N)$ also has a close connection with extensive interpretation. In the neutral form we virtually deal with a Galilean manifold. If in such a manifold I , N are the incident and normal components with reference to a , we can, by a rotation, bring a to coincidence with l_1 , or some l_a , and then $(I - N)$ becomes the capital linity P_1 (which reverses the sign of l_1 in every term of q), introduced at the outset of our subject. The properties of I , N , $(I - N)$, may be based on this connection

with P_1 , through neutral to invariant forms. However, it is perfectly easy to prove directly that, say, I' , has subextensive significance, for we have defined thus

$$I'\beta = \alpha V_0 \eta \alpha \beta, \quad I'u = V_{a\alpha} V_{a-1} \eta \alpha u,$$

and to show that I' has subextensive significance we have to prove that

$$I'u = -V_a I' \xi V_{a-1} \xi u,$$

which is obvious as soon as stated.]

Maxwell's scheme also connects $\mathbf{K}$ with $\mathbf{E}$ by the self-conjugate linity conductivity. In our case express this first with Galilean co-ordinates. We have

$$\sum_{a=1}^3 E_a l_a = V_1 l_4 \omega^\times = R N_4 \dot{\mathbf{K}}$$

where R is put for resistivity. This generalizes to

$$N' \dot{\mathbf{K}} = \dot{\phi} V_1 I \omega^\times, \quad \dot{\phi} = N' \dot{\phi} N = \dot{\phi}' =)(\dot{\phi}. \quad (7)$$

where $\dot{\phi}$ is conductivity, a vector linity.

It appears to me an impressive fact that Maxwell's analysis of the electromagnetic field was so wonderfully true to the nature of things, that not one single feature of his scheme, so far considered, requires the slightest revision when examined with the powerful searchlight of Relativity. Only when the structure perforce comes into contact with Newtonian mechanics, as is the case in what we are about to consider, does it require, along with classical mechanics, to be amended.

For stress put

$$\dot{M} \alpha^\times = -\frac{1}{2} \alpha^\times V_0 \dot{\omega} \omega^\times + V_1 (V_1 \alpha^\times \dot{\omega}') \omega^\times. \quad (8)$$

We have

$$\dot{M}_9 \nabla_9 = -\frac{1}{2} \nabla V_0 \dot{\omega}' \omega^\times + V_1 (V_1 \nabla_9 \dot{\omega}') \omega_9^\times + v^\times$$

by (2a) and (3a). Now

$$V_1 (V_1 \nabla_9 \dot{\omega}') \omega_9^\times = \nabla_9 V_0 \dot{\omega}' \omega_9^\times - V_1 \dot{\omega}' V_3 \nabla \omega^\times$$

of which the last term is zero by (4). Hence

$$\left. \begin{aligned} v^\times &= \dot{M}_9 \nabla_9 + \frac{1}{2} (\nabla_8 - \nabla_9) V_0 \dot{\omega}'_8 \omega_9^\times \\ &= \dot{M}_9 \nabla_9 + \frac{1}{2} \nabla_9 V_0 \omega^\times \psi_9^{-1} \omega^\times \end{aligned} \right\} \quad (9)$$

by (5). By using $\dot{\omega}$ instead of $\omega^\times$ the last term on the right becomes $-\frac{1}{2} \nabla_9 V_0 \omega^\times \psi_9^{-1} \omega^\times$. Because of the factor l^{-1} in $\psi^{-1} = l^{-1} \psi^{-1}$ we may speak of ψ^{-1} as an *anti*-density.

§ 21. *STATIONARY ACTION IN A RIEMANN MANIFOLD.*—In our theorems of integration $d\dot{p}_c$ being equal to $V_c dp_1 dp_2 \dots dp_c$ is contravariant. But since

$$l db = l V_0 d\alpha dp_n$$

is an invariant, $d\alpha$, must be a covariant vector anti-density, and, similarly, $d\dot{p}_c$ in general (including db) is a covariant multienion anti-density.

(8) and (9) of §20 are unsatisfactory in that $\dot{M}\theta$ is not apparently self-conjugate, and from the second term on the right of (9) the force (cum power), per unit volume, cannot be expressed as a stress even of the non self-conjugate kind. But the pioneers of Relativity have developed a principle of stationary action which has for consequence that all of the equations of §20 may be retained, and that $\dot{M}$ of (8) *is* self-conjugate; and by what seems little more than a bold assumption as to the nature of things, they conclude that the intractable last term of (9) need not trouble us, because force generated by the field need not be begotten by stress; they give us something else instead, as will appear below. [I think I have here credited the pioneers with just a little more than they have set forth, but no more than such as, by small additions, can be included.]

Although in the main we copy their procedure, yet in two important respects we depart from it, and in doing so return much more nearly than they do to Maxwell's outlook. First, we keep in mind the application to matter in bulk; and, secondly, we abjure the use of λ *in toto*. Probably Heaviside, among those who studied these matters in the days before the advent of Relativity, as we know it to-day, emphasised as much as any writer the view that the potentials of λ have nothing to do with actualities, unless among such are to be reckoned the imperfections of our mathematics. In returning to the procedure I adopted in 1892,⁴ of taking Maxwell's $\mathbf{H}$ and $\mathbf{D}$ as the fundamental (three-dimensional) vectors of the field, instead of any of $\mathbf{A}$, $\mathbf{B}$, $\mathbf{C}$, $\mathbf{K}$, or $\mathbf{E}$, I find that the potentials can be completely ignored, that they are not wanted even as a mathematical crutch, and that the ignoring of them considerably simplifies the preliminary organising plans of our exploration. The electro-magnetic terms are all dependent on a single arbitrary scalar function of the nV_2 called $\dot{\omega}$ in §20.

Let us recall that a particle of matter, with three dimensional extension, occupies a four-dimensional tube in the space-time continuum. The strength of this tube is the invariant constant (static) mass $d\dot{M} = l dM$ of the particle. The three dimensional anti-density covariant cross-section being $d\alpha$, an element of "length" of the tube being the proper time ds , corresponding to the contravariant vector dp , where $d\alpha$ and dp are both time-like, ι being the unit tangent vector dp/ds , db the four-dimensional volume of the element, we have

$$ds^2 = V_0 dp \theta dp, \quad \iota = dp/ds, \quad db = V_0 d\alpha dp. \quad (1)$$

and

$$d\dot{M} \cdot ds = m db, \quad (2)$$

⁴"On the Mathematical Theory of Electromagnetism," 'Phil. Trans.,' 1893.